Team clustering results vs Team squad composition

Are team clusters and team squad composition related?

Do different clusters give different minutes to different player types?

At k = 2,

- Patient teams give more minutes for short passing keepers and line holding center backs.
- Front-footed teams give more minutes for passing wingbacks, while patient teams give more minutes for deep full backs.
- While soft shares were quite even, in terms of hard shares, front-footed teams give more minutes to progressive passing midfielders, while patient teams give more minutes to deep pivot midfielders and advanced carrying midfielders.
- Patient teams give more minutes for wide conservative carrying midfielders, while front-footed teams give more minutes for wide playmakers.
- Patient teams give more minutes for poachers, while front-footed teams give more minutes to advanced forwards.

At k = 3,

- Similar trends at the back can be seen as k = 2.
- Central combiners give more minutes to progressive passers but fewer to deep pivot midfielders.
- Central combiners give more minutes to wide playmakers, while wide crossers give more minutes to advanced wingers.
- Wide crossers give fewer minutes to poachers, but more to advanced forwards and target forwards.

At k = 4,

- High pressers show their front-footedness in more minutes to long passing keepers, stopper center backs, and progressive passers.

Do the same trends remain across leagues?

A difference counts when it is at least 5 percent and points the same way in at least 3 of the 4 leagues.

- At k = 2, the patient/front-foot squad differences hold across leagues: patient teams give more minutes to advanced carriers, line holding center backs, and short passing keepers, while fewer minutes to progressive passers and progressive passing wingbacks.
- The signature for patient group remains the same throughout different values of k.
- At k = 3, central combiners give more minutes to progressive passers rather than deep pivots and more minutes to wide playmakers, while wide crossers give fewer minutes to advanced carriers and poachers.
- At k = 4, high pressing teams have more long passing keepers and stopper center backs but fewer advanced carriers.

Therefore, the squad pattern is mostly consistent among patient and front-footed teams, while differences among front-footed styles were smaller but still consistent across different leagues.

Caveats

- Team style is made up of players' own actions, so the link between squad and style is automatic.
- 10 clubs have no clustered wingers, and 2 clubs have no clustered center forwards, so they sit out.
- Midfield difference is only seen in hard shares rather than soft, as midfielders' similarity scores are spread evenly across three types.

Appendix

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A1. Squad mix by cluster, k = 2

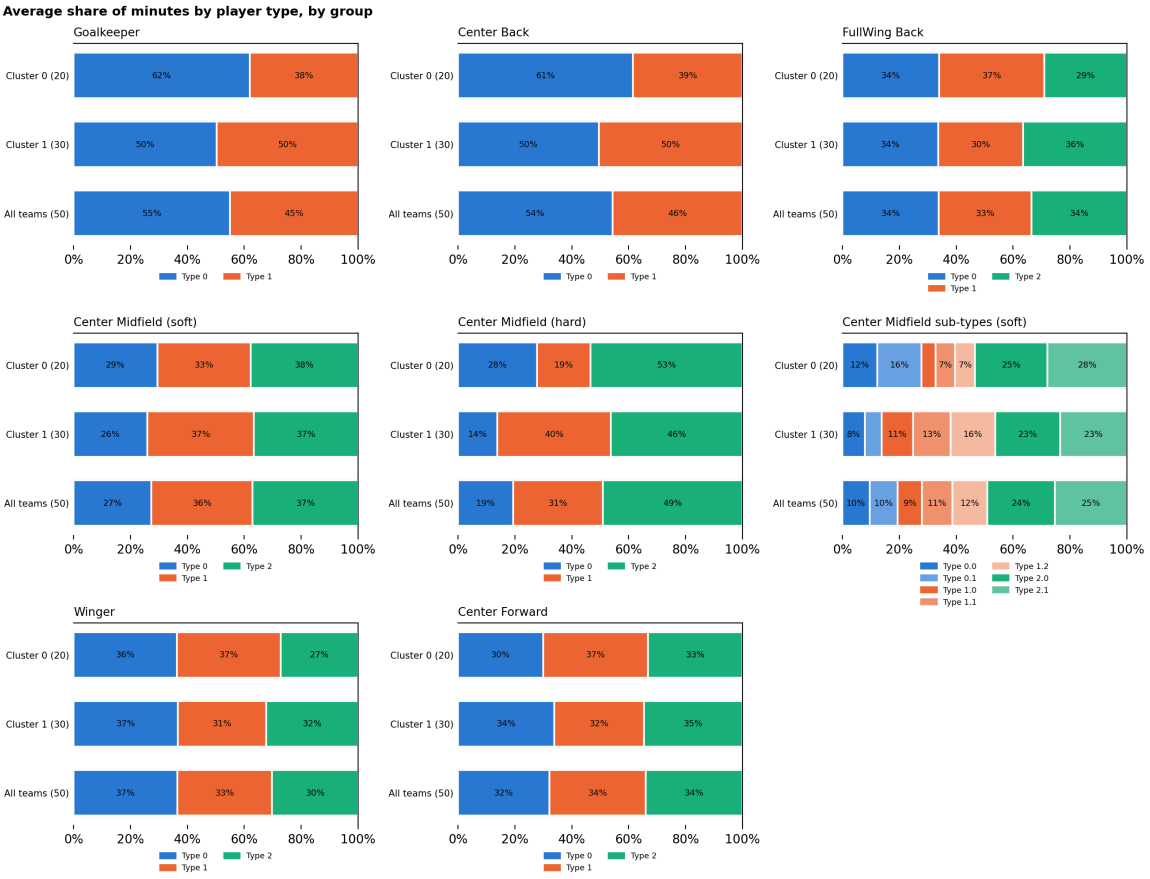


Figure A1. Each cluster's share of minutes by player type at k = 2, against the 50-team average.

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A2. Player-type split by team, k = 2: goalkeeper and centre-back

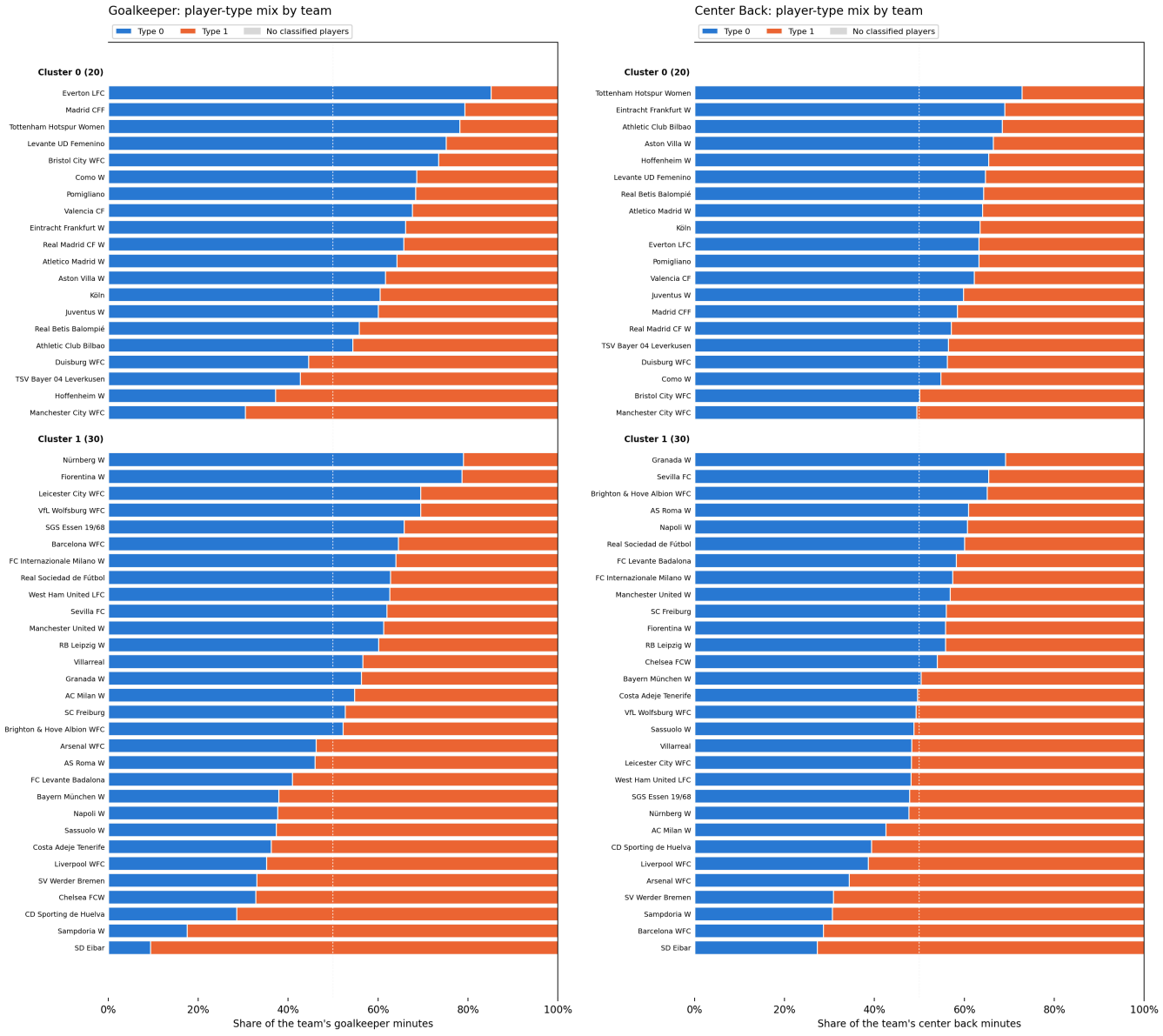


Figure A2. Every team's split of goalkeeper (left) and centre-back (right) minutes across player types at k = 2, teams grouped by cluster.

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A3. Player-type split by team, k = 2: full/wing-back and midfield

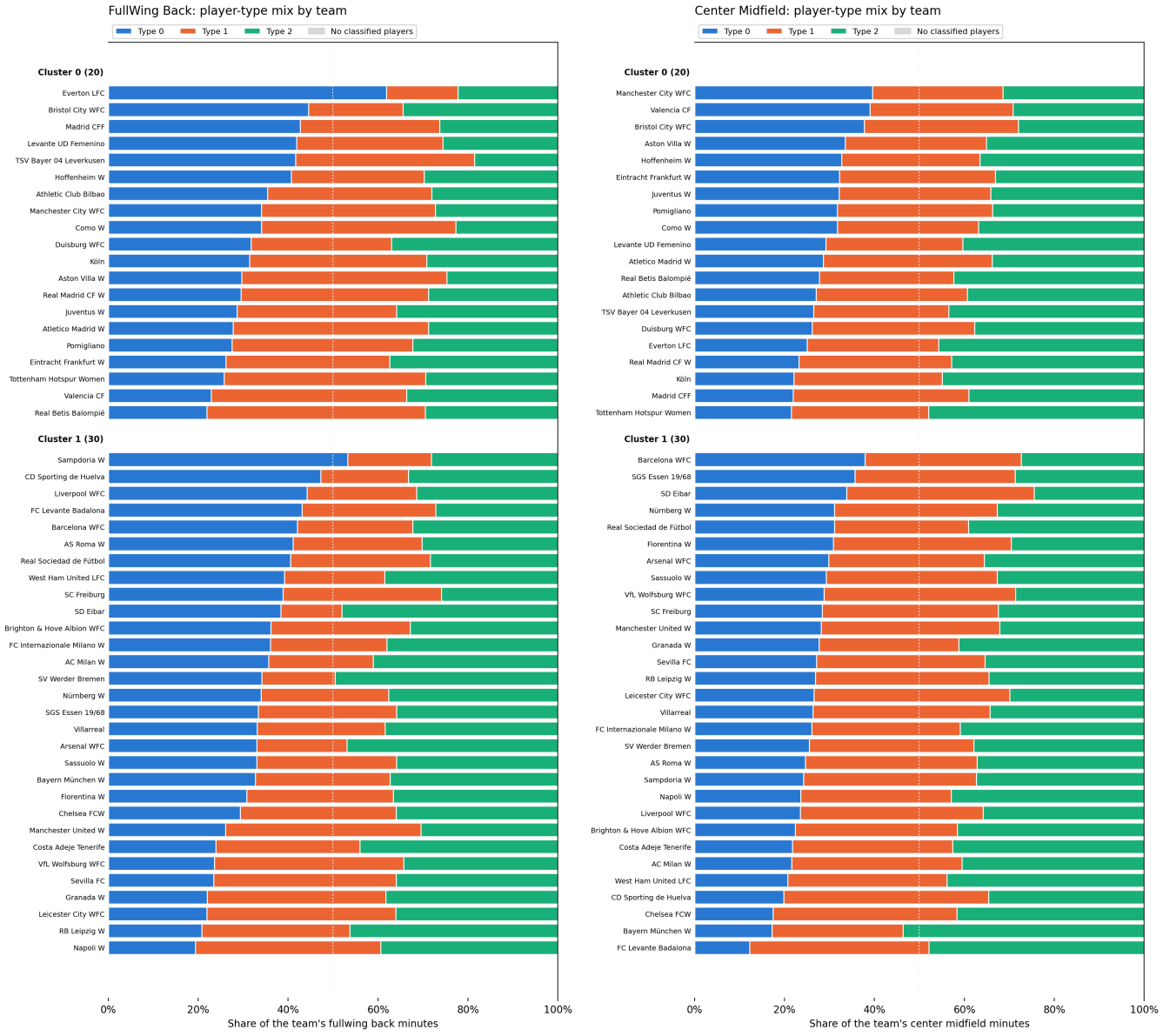


Figure A3. Every team's split of full/wing-back (left) and midfield (right) minutes across player types at k = 2, teams grouped by cluster. Shares are soft shares, so the midfield difference seen in hard shares shows less here.

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A4. Player-type split by team, k = 2: winger and centre-forward

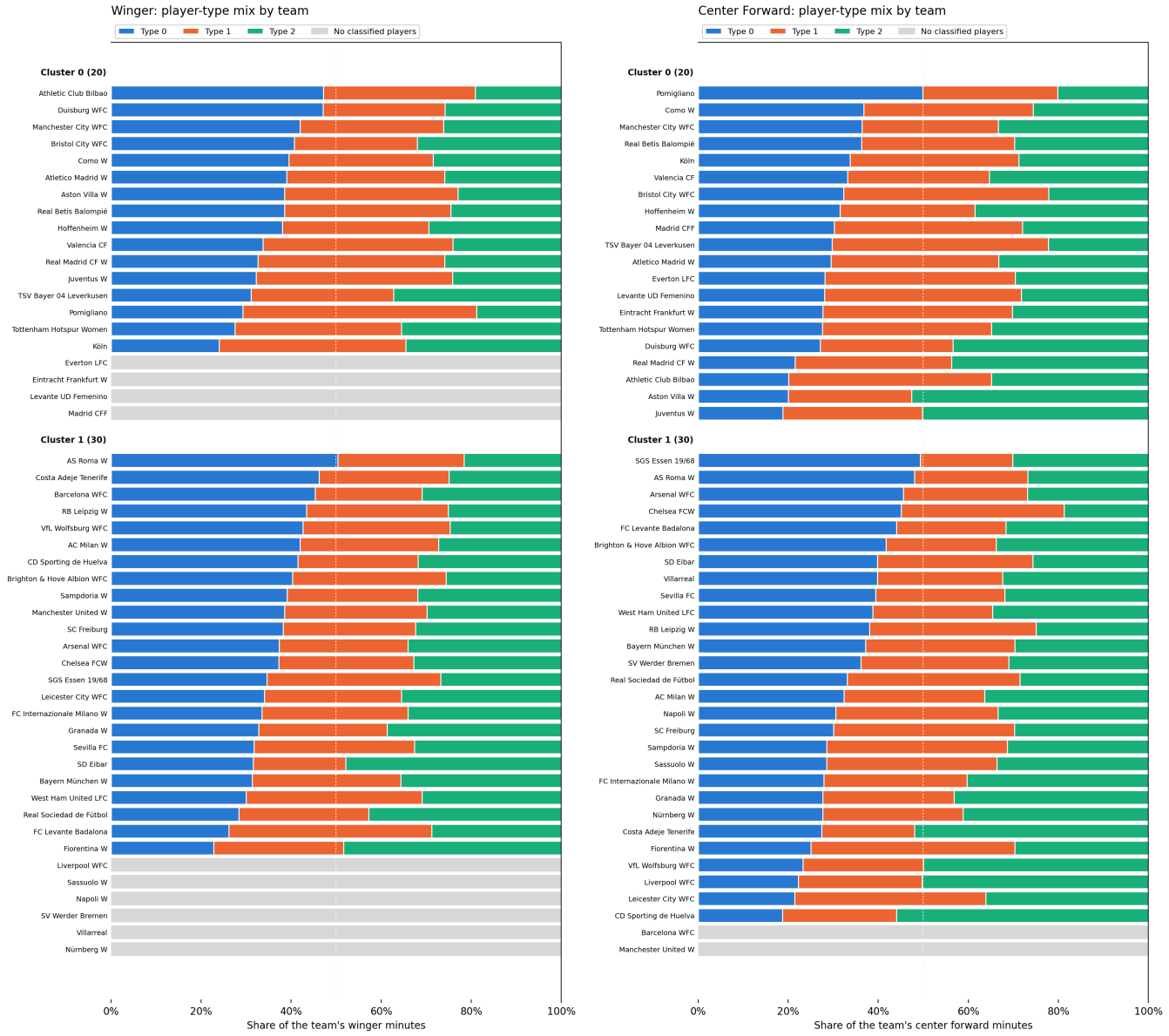


Figure A4. Every team's split of winger (left) and centre-forward (right) minutes across player types at k = 2, teams grouped by cluster.

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A5. Squad mix by cluster, k = 3

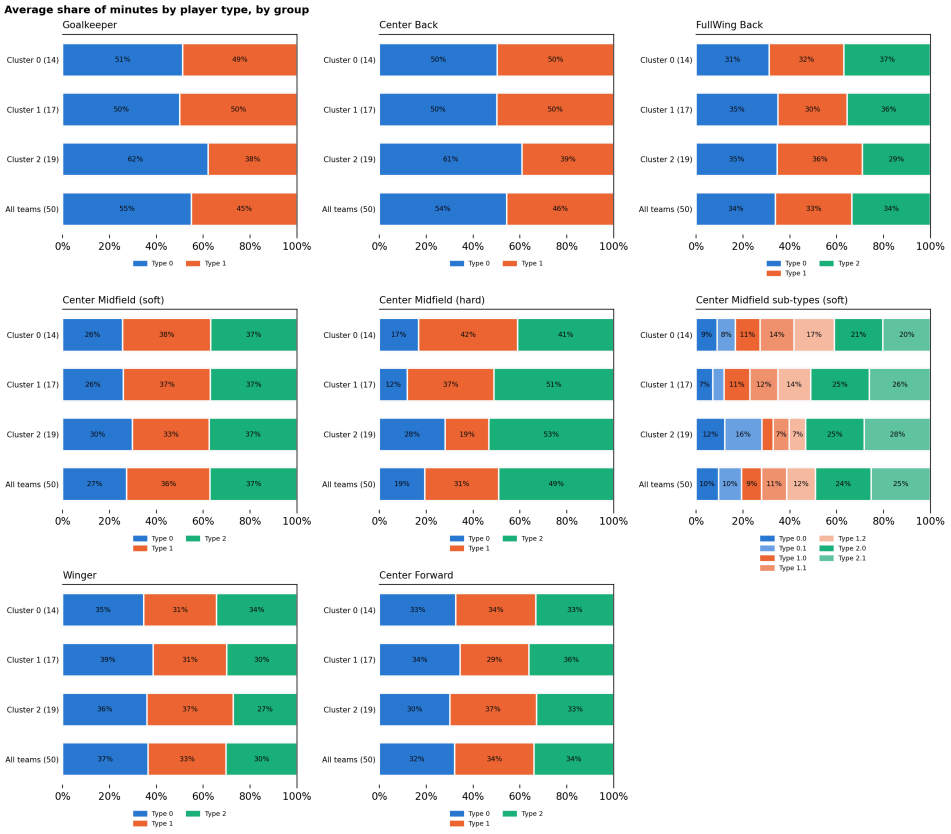


Figure A5. Each cluster's share of minutes by player type at k = 3, against the 50-team average.

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A6. Player-type split by team, k = 3: goalkeeper and centre-back

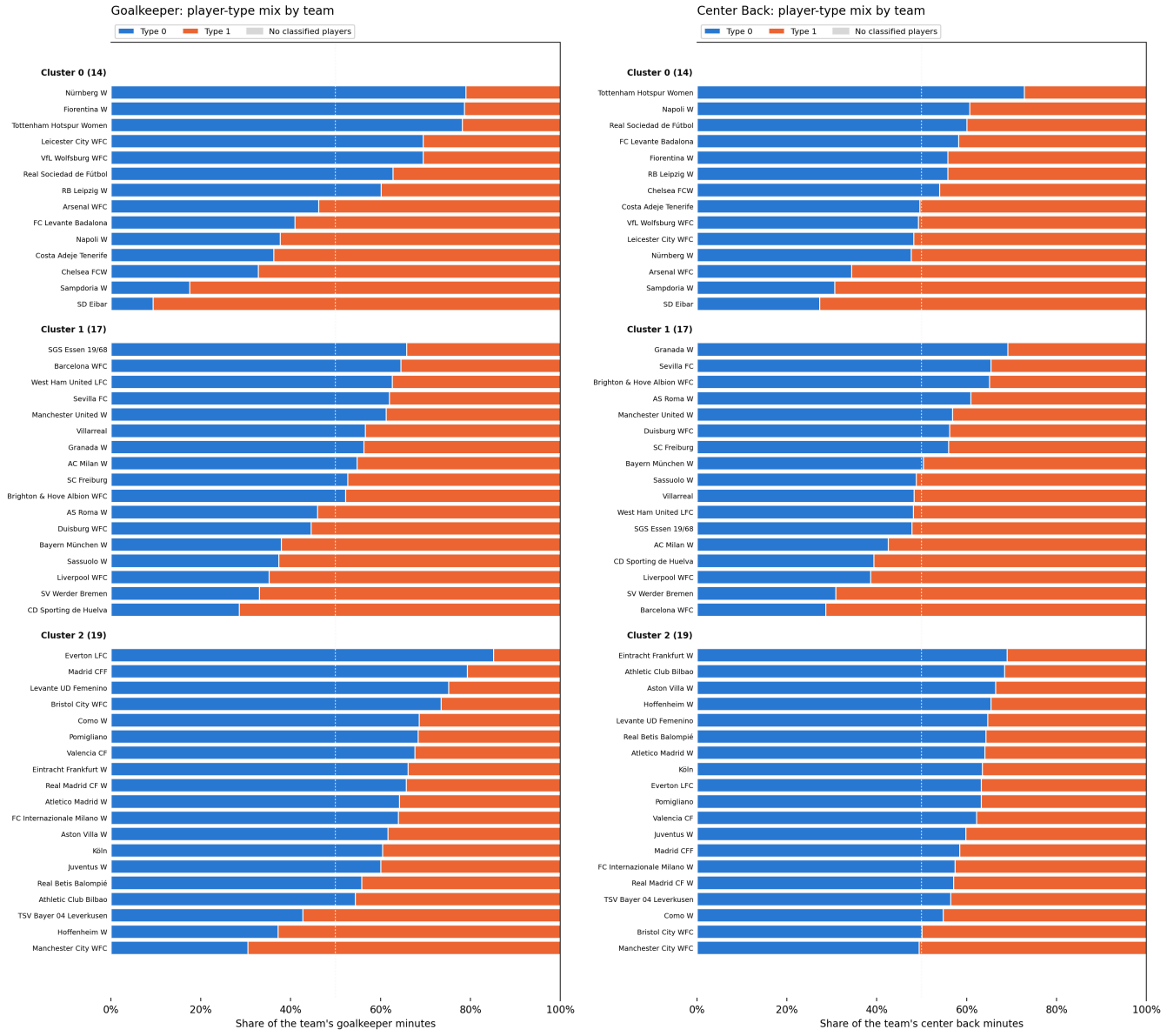


Figure A6. Every team's split of goalkeeper (left) and centre-back (right) minutes across player types at k = 3, teams grouped by cluster.

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A7. Player-type split by team, k = 3: full/wing-back and midfield

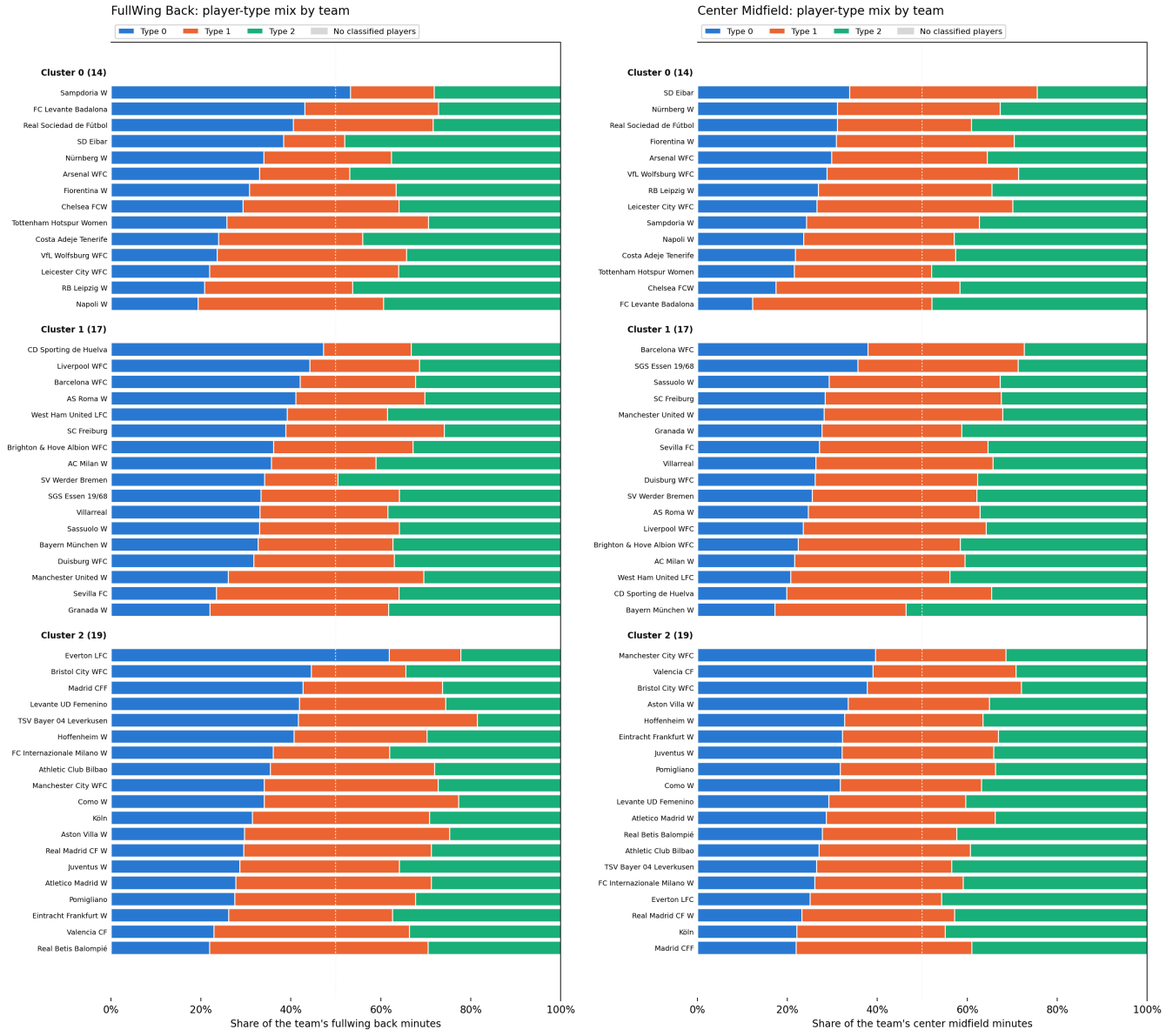


Figure A7. Every team's split of full/wing-back (left) and midfield (right) minutes across player types at k = 3, teams grouped by cluster. Shares are soft shares, so the midfield difference seen in hard shares shows less here.

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A8. Player-type split by team, k = 3: winger and centre-forward

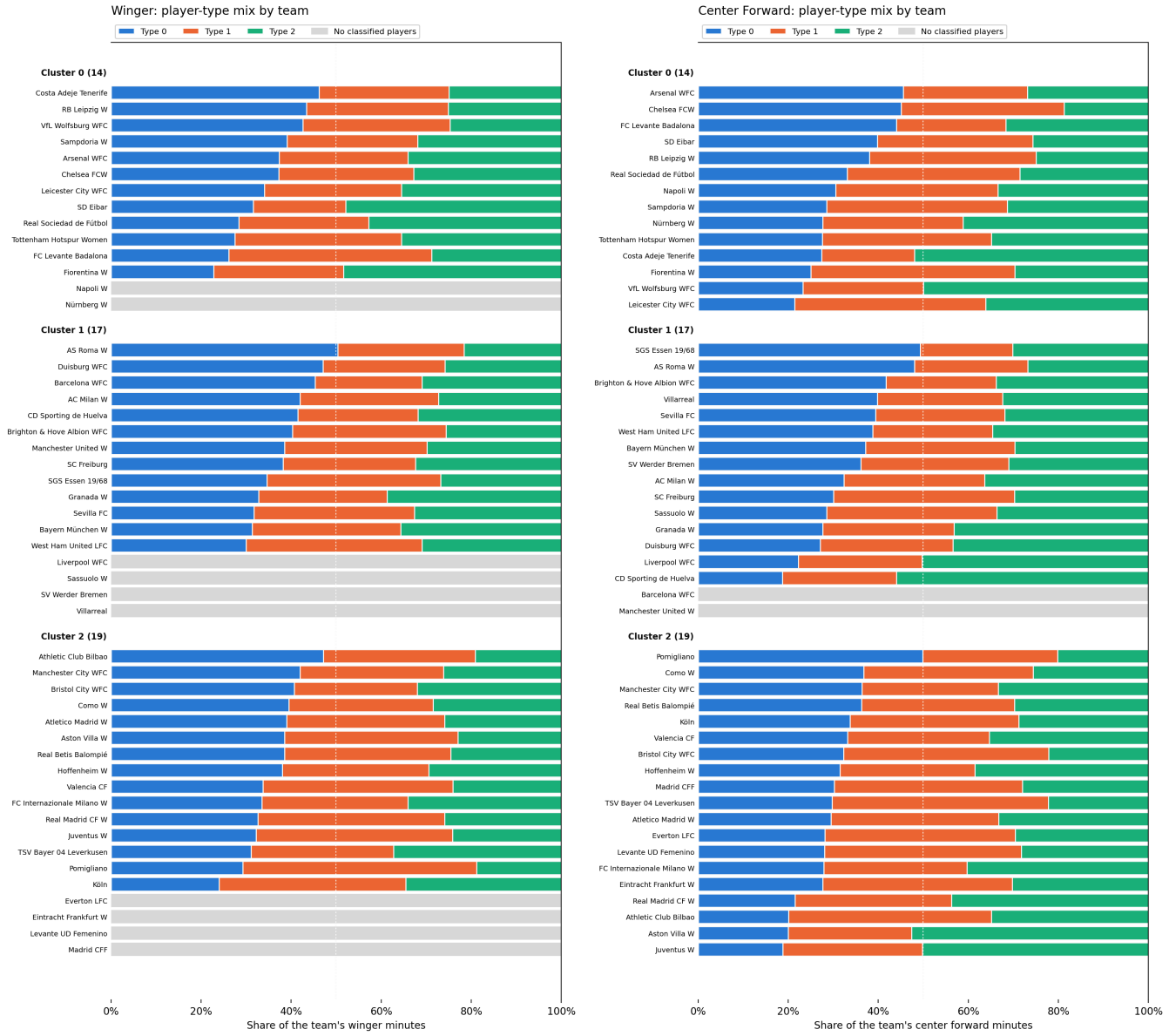


Figure A8. Every team's split of winger (left) and centre-forward (right) minutes across player types at k = 3, teams grouped by cluster.

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A9. Squad mix by cluster, k = 4

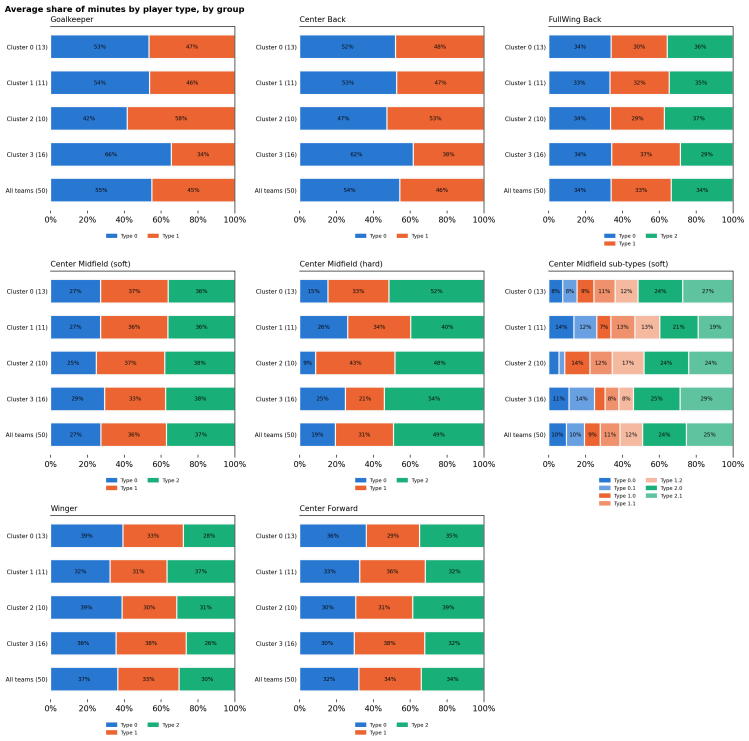


Figure A9. Each cluster's share of minutes by player type at k = 4, against the 50-team average.

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A10. Player-type split by team, k = 4: goalkeeper and centre-back

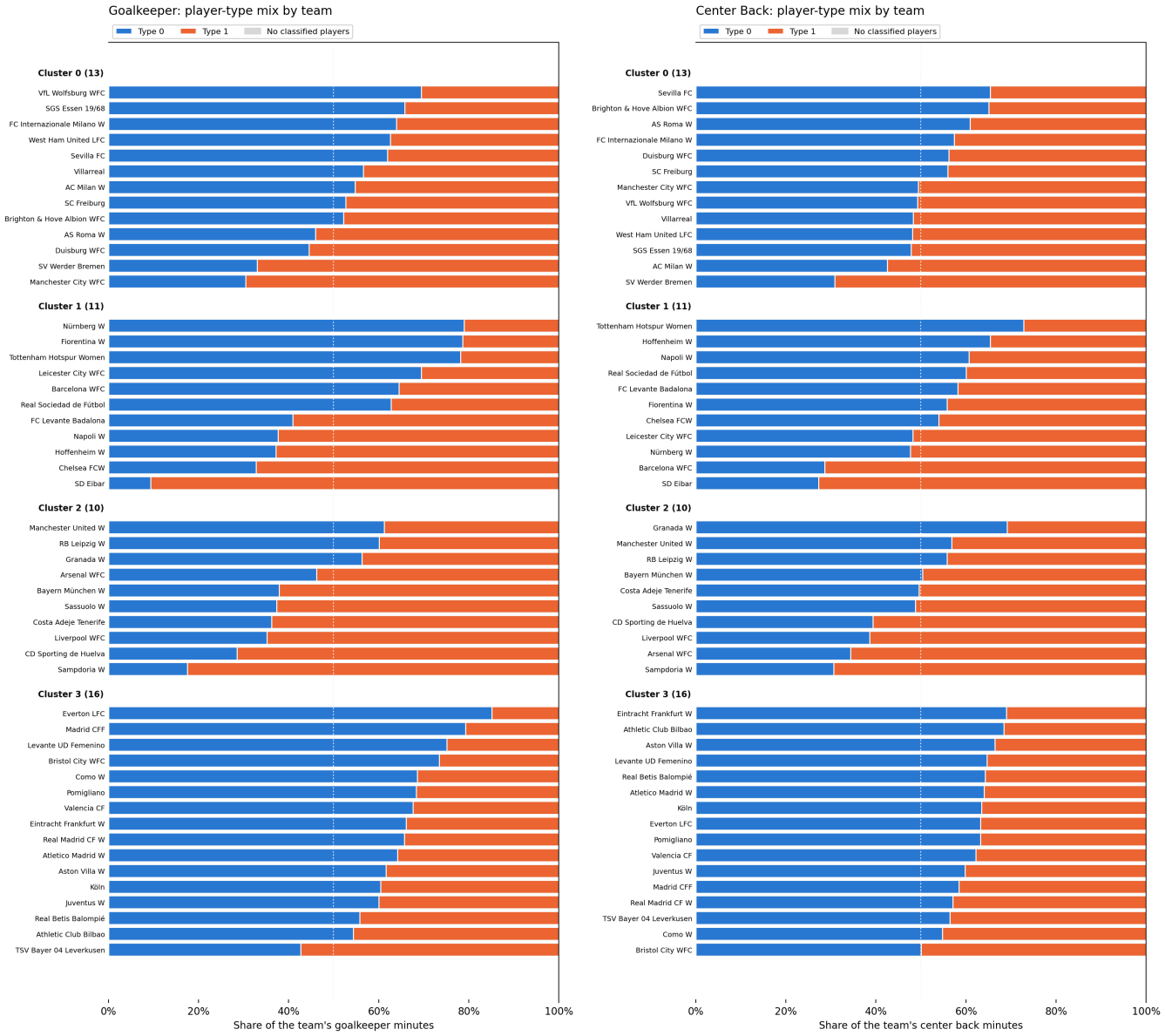


Figure A10. Every team's split of goalkeeper (left) and centre-back (right) minutes across player types at k = 4, teams grouped by cluster.

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A11. Player-type split by team, k = 4: full/wing-back and midfield

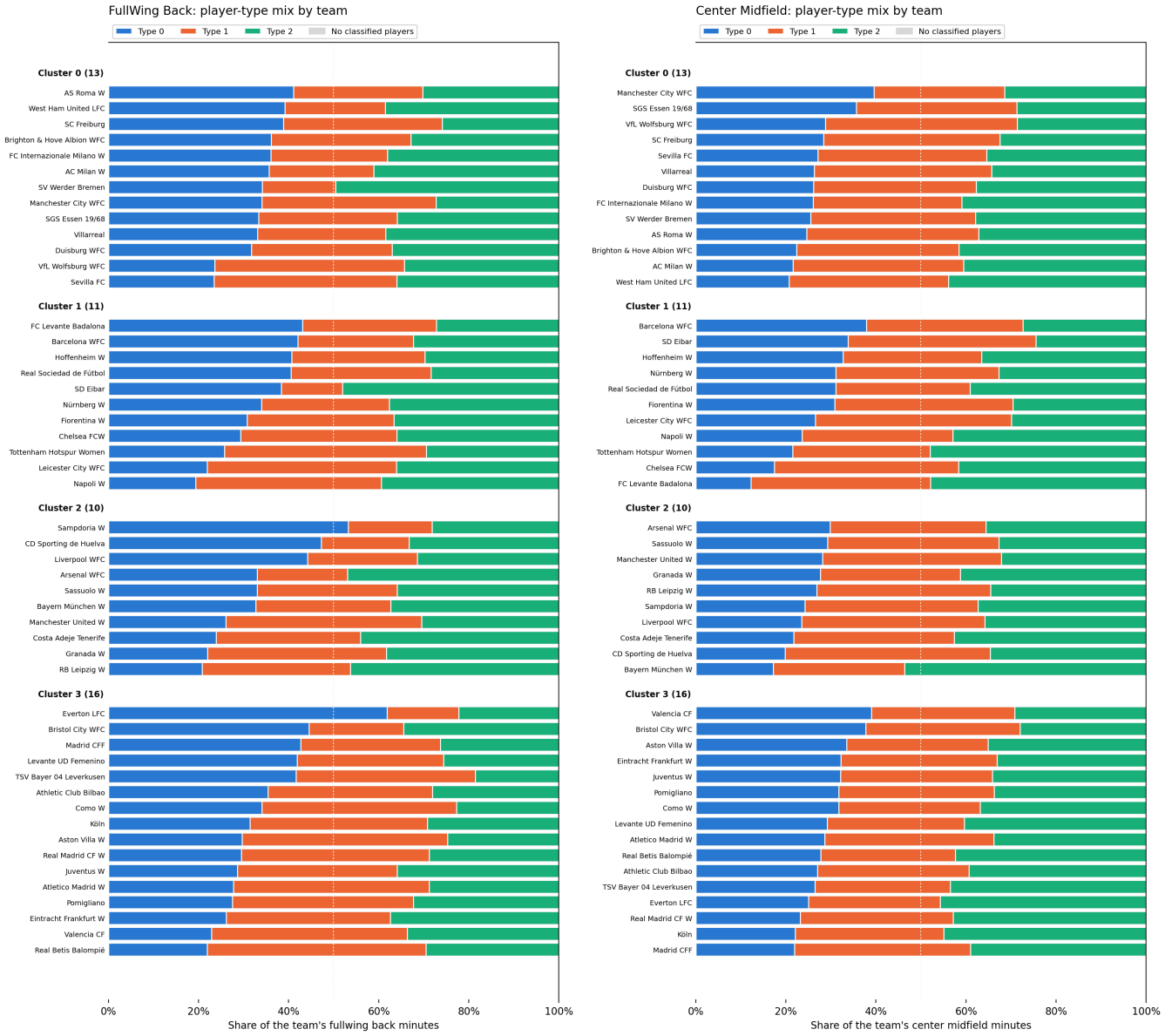


Figure A11. Every team's split of full/wing-back (left) and midfield (right) minutes across player types at k = 4, teams grouped by cluster. Shares are soft shares, so the midfield difference seen in hard shares shows less here.

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A12. Player-type split by team, k = 4: winger and centre-forward

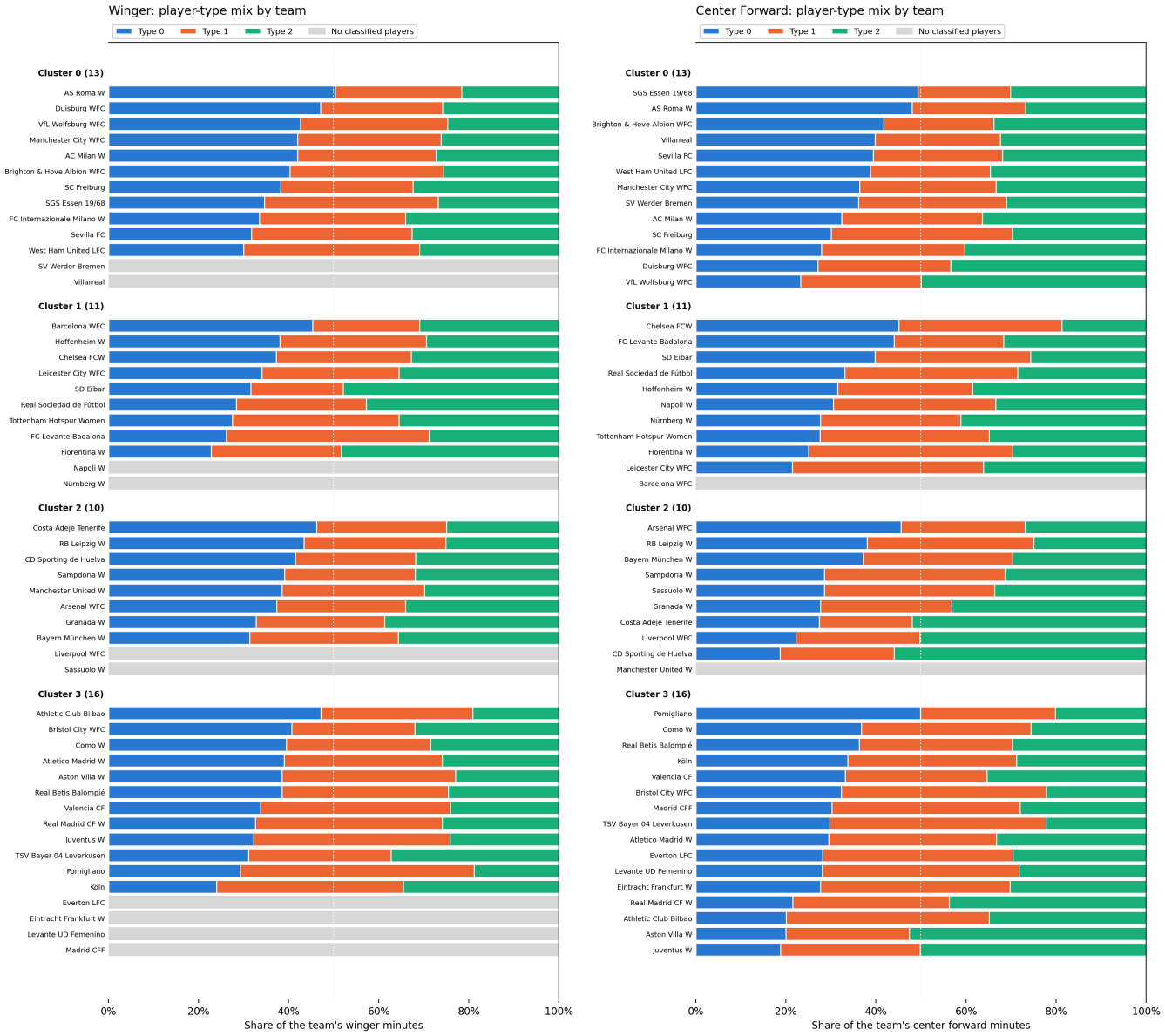


Figure A12. Every team's split of winger (left) and centre-forward (right) minutes across player types at k = 4, teams grouped by cluster.